

Mel Rowlands

PRODUCT DESIGNER

CORE SKILLS

Product design

End-to-end UX, IA, interaction design, UI, user flows, prototyping, design systems

B2B & digital platforms

Dashboards, portals, complex IA, multi-stakeholder environments, technical audiences

Brand & visual design

Brand identity, design systems, packaging, visual communication

Tools

Figma, Claude Code, HTML/CSS, Git/GitHub, Adobe Creative Suite

AI-augmented shipping

Agent-assisted prototyping & production; AI in research, ideation and copy

HIGHLIGHTS

B2B platform specialist

Dashboards, portals, complex data-heavy interfaces

Full-range designer

UX to brand – versatile across a studio context

Ships, not just designs

Comfortable in the codebase via AI-assisted workflows

User research & testing

Validates design decisions with real user behaviour

AVAILABLE

Fully remote · Cape Town-based · UK passport. Comfortable across UK and US East Coast hours. Open to full-time or contract.

REFERENCES

Written reference from Timothy Sewell, Managing Director, Dataloop. Further references on request.

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linkedin.com/in/melanierowlands · Cape Town, South Africa · Remote

PROFILE

Senior product designer with **20+ years** of design depth and a modern, AI-forward workflow. I specialise in making complex, information-dense products clear and usable – for professional audiences, technical buyers, and senior decision-makers. I work across the full design range: UX and IA through to polished UI, brand and visual systems. I design in Figma and ship with Claude Code, taking ideas from sketch to working product. Most recently I co-founded and led design on a digital learning platform. Before that: B2B platform design, brand studio leadership, and investment research.

Taking complex, technical, information-dense problems and turning them into clear, intuitive experiences – for audiences who need to make decisions fast.

SELECTED EXPERIENCE

Co-founder & Lead Designer · iNGENiO Education

2023 – Present

Digital learning platform · Cape Town / remote

- Owned **end-to-end product design** for a complex subscription platform serving schools and families – IA, UX, interaction design, UI and visual design, implemented on the live stack.
- Structured a **dense library of 90+ courses** into a scannable, decision-friendly experience, addressing choice paralysis and simplifying complex content hierarchies for non-technical users.
- Designed an in-product **guided onboarding path** with progressive disclosure and filters, driving first-session engagement and feature discovery.
- Designed and prototyped interaction patterns for new features using **rapid Figma + AI-assisted prototyping**, testing with users before committing engineering effort.
- Ships with an AI-forward workflow: Figma for design, **Claude Code** for prototyping and component-level production on a live WordPress, WooCommerce and LearnDash stack.

Contract Designer · Dataloop

2021 – 2023

Data & software consultancy · contract

- Designed across **client-facing portals, dashboards and internal applications** for a B2B data and software consultancy, turning dense, technical, data-heavy requirements into clean, usable interfaces.
- Worked directly with engineering and product teams to **balance real user needs against technical constraints** – practical, grounded product design in a complex, multi-stakeholder B2B environment.
- Designed for **professional, technical audiences** – data teams, business stakeholders and senior decision-makers; translating specialist domain knowledge into intuitive UI.
- Delivered to a high standard in a fast-moving consultancy, managing multiple concurrent workstreams.

Co-owner & Designer · Fineday Design Studio

2015 – 2021

Brand & packaging studio · co-founded

- Seven years building **brand and packaging systems** for food and drink businesses, with work reaching retail shelves locally and abroad – including Yuppie Chef, Sarah Graham, Jimmy's and Shackleton.
- Led two **licensed international surface-pattern collaborations** (Studio E Fabrics and Nested Bean, USA), managing craft and consistency across distributed partners.

Analyst, Investment Research · Goldman Sachs

2000 – 2007

London

- Seven years producing careful, high-stakes analytical work for institutional clients. The research rigour and attention to detail still shape how I approach every design problem.